

Chapter 35 — Hithpael Weak-Form Identification Drill

BBH Chapter 35 · Hithpael Weak Verbs

Part A: identify conjugation, PGN, and root (forms grouped by weak class). Part B: mixed forms — identify weak class first, then conjugation, PGN, and root. Answer key is on the last page.

Sibilant Metathesis: when R1 = שׁ/שׂ/ס/צ, the Hithpael ת swaps with R1 (and ת → ט before צ). E.g., שׁוּחַתְּ → שׁוּחַתְּ; שׂוּחַתְּ → שׂוּחַתְּ; שׁוּחַתְּ → שׁוּחַתְּ; שׂוּחַתְּ → שׂוּחַתְּ. I-guttural: composite shewa under R1 (e.g., הִתְחַלֵּתְּ). III-he: apocopation in wayyiqtol (הִתְחַלֵּתְּ drops: יִתְחַלֵּתְּ from חִלַּתְּ).

Group 1: III-he

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
1	יִתְגַּל				
2	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ				
3	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהוּ				
4	תִּתְכַּסֶּה				
5	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ				

Group 2: I-guttural

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
6	מִתְחַלֵּךְ				
7	יִתְחַלֵּךְ				
8	יִתְחַבֵּא				
9	הִתְעַנִּי				
10	יִתְחַזֵּק				

Group 3: Sibilant Metathesis (R1 = שׁ/שׂ/ס/צ)

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
11	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ				
12	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהוּ				
13	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ				
14	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר				
15	יִשְׁתַּמֵּם				

Group 4: I-nun

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
16	מתְּנַחֵם				
17	יִתְנַחֲמוּ				
18	יִתְנַחֲלוּ				
19	אֶתְנַחֵלָה				
20	מִתְנַדְּבִים				

Part B — Mixed Forms

#	Form	Reference	Weak Class	Conjugation	PGN	Root
21	וַיִּשְׁתַּח					
22	וַיִּתְאַבֵּל					
23	הִתְקַדְּשׁוּ					
24	וַיִּתְפַּלֵּל					
25	הִתְהַלֵּל					
26	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר					
27	מִתְחַזְּקִים					
28	יִתְגַּלְּגַל					
29	הִתְרוֹמֵם					
30	הִשְׁתַּוֵּלֵּל					

Reflection Questions

1. Sibilant metathesis (items 11–15, Part B items 21, 26, 30): write the expected (pre-metathesis) form of הִתְחַשֵּׁחַ. Then identify which letters swapped.
2. I-guttural Hithpael (items 6–10): how would you distinguish a Hithpael I-guttural form (e.g., יִתְחַלֵּה מִ) from a Piel I-guttural form (e.g., יִחַלֵּה מִ)?
3. III-he apocopation: items 1, 2, 5 (wayyiqtol) drop the final ה. Item 3 (qatal 3ms) retains it. Why does the qatal retain the ה but the wayyiqtol does not?

Answer Key — Part A

Group 1: III-he

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
1	יִתְגַּל				
✓	יִתְגַּל	Gen 9:21	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ג.ל.ה · III-he apocopated; ה dropped
2	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ				
✓	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ	Gen 18:2	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ש.ח.ו · metathesis (ש' + ת swap) +
3	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהוּ				
✓	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהוּ	Gen 22:5	Qatal	3ms	ש.ח.ו · metathesis + III-he; qamets +
4	תִּתְכַּסֶּה				
✓	תִּתְכַּסֶּה	Gen 24:65	Wayyiqtol	3fs	כ.ס.ה · strong R1; III-he seghol + ה
5	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ				
✓	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ	Gen 33:7	Wayyiqtol	3mp	ש.ח.ו · metathesis + III-he; 3mp ו ·

Group 2: I-guttural

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
6	מִתְהַלֵּךְ				
✓	מִתְהַלֵּךְ	Gen 3:8	Participle	ms	ה.ל.ך · I-gutt (ה); hateph-patach under
7	יִתְהַלֵּךְ				
✓	יִתְהַלֵּךְ	Gen 5:22	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ה.ל.ך · same root; hateph-patach +
8	יִתְחַבֵּא				
✓	יִתְחַבֵּא	Gen 3:8	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ח.ב.א · I-gutt (ח) + III-aleph; hateph
9	הִתְעַנֵּי				
✓	הִתְעַנֵּי	Gen 16:9	Imperative	2fs	ע.נ.י · I-gutt (ע) + III-he; hateph under ע
10	יִתְחַזֵּק				
✓	יִתְחַזֵּק	Exo 7:13	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ח.ז.ק · I-gutt (ח); hateph-patach;

Group 3: Sibilant Metathesis (R1 = ■■/■■/■/■)

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
11	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ				
✓	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּ	Gen 19:1	Wayyiqtol	3ms	שׁ, ח, ה · metathesis: ת + שׁ → שׁ + ת ;
12	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהָ				
✓	הִשְׁתַּחֲוּהָ	Gen 23:7	Qatal	3ms	שׁ, ח, ה · metathesis + III-he qatal; ה
13	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ				
✓	יִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ	Gen 33:7	Wayyiqtol	3mp	שׁ, ח, ה · same as #11; 3mp ו ending
14	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר				
✓	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר	Deu 4:9	Imperative	2ms	שׁ, מ, ר · metathesis: ה שׁ, י instead of
15	וַיִּשְׁתַּמֵּם				
✓	וַיִּשְׁתַּמֵּם	Dan 4:16	Wayyiqtol	3ms	שׁ, מ, ם · metathesis; Geminate root

Group 4: I-nun

#	Form	Reference	Conjugation	PGN	Root
16	מִתְנַחֵם				
✓	מִתְנַחֵם	Gen 27:42	Participle	ms	נ, ח, ם · I-nun RETAINED (not
17	וַיִּתְנַחֲמוּ				
✓	וַיִּתְנַחֲמוּ	Gen 37:35	Wayyiqtol	3mp	נ, ח, ם · same root; 3mp ending; nun
18	וַיִּתְנַחֲלוּ				
✓	וַיִּתְנַחֲלוּ	Gen 37:18	Wayyiqtol	3mp	נ, ח, ם · I-nun retained; dagesh in כּ =
19	אֶתְנַחֲלָהּ				
✓	אֶתְנַחֲלָהּ	Gen 33:14	Cohortative	1cs	נ, ח, ם · I-nun retained; hateph-patach
20	מִתְנַדְּבִים				
✓	מִתְנַדְּבִים	Ezr 1:6	Participle	mp	נ, ד, ב · I-nun retained; plural מ ת, ב, ד +

Answer Key — Part B

#	Form	Reference	Weak Class	Conjugation	PGN	Root
21	וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ					
✓	וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ	Gen 24:26	Sibilant metathesis +	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ה.ח.שׁ
22	וַיִּתְאַבֵּל					
✓	וַיִּתְאַבֵּל	Gen 37:34	Strong	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ל.ב.א
23	הִתְקַדְּשׁוּ					
✓	הִתְקַדְּשׁוּ	Exo 19:22	Strong	Imperative	2mp	שׁ.ד.ק
24	וַיִּתְפַּלֵּל					
✓	וַיִּתְפַּלֵּל	Gen 20:17	Strong	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ל.ל.פ
25	הִתְהַלֵּל					
✓	הִתְהַלֵּל	Jer 9:22	I-gutt (ה) + Geminate	Imperative	2ms	ל.ל.ה
26	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר					
✓	הִשְׁתַּמֵּר	Gen 31:24	Sibilant metathesis	Imperative	2ms	ר.מ.שׁ
27	מִתְחַזְּקִים					
✓	מִתְחַזְּקִים	Neh 3:20	I-gutt (ח)	Participle	mp	ק.ז.ח
28	יִתְגַּלֵּגַל					
✓	יִתְגַּלֵּגַל	Ruth 3:8	Geminate	Wayyiqtol	3ms	ל.ל.ג
29	הִתְרוֹמֵם					
✓	הִתְרוֹמֵם	Ps 46:11	Biconsonantal/Geminate	Imperative	2ms	מ.ר
30	הִשְׁתַּלֵּל					
✓	הִשְׁתַּלֵּל	Isa 51:7	Sibilant metathesis	Qatal	3ms	ל.ל.שׁ